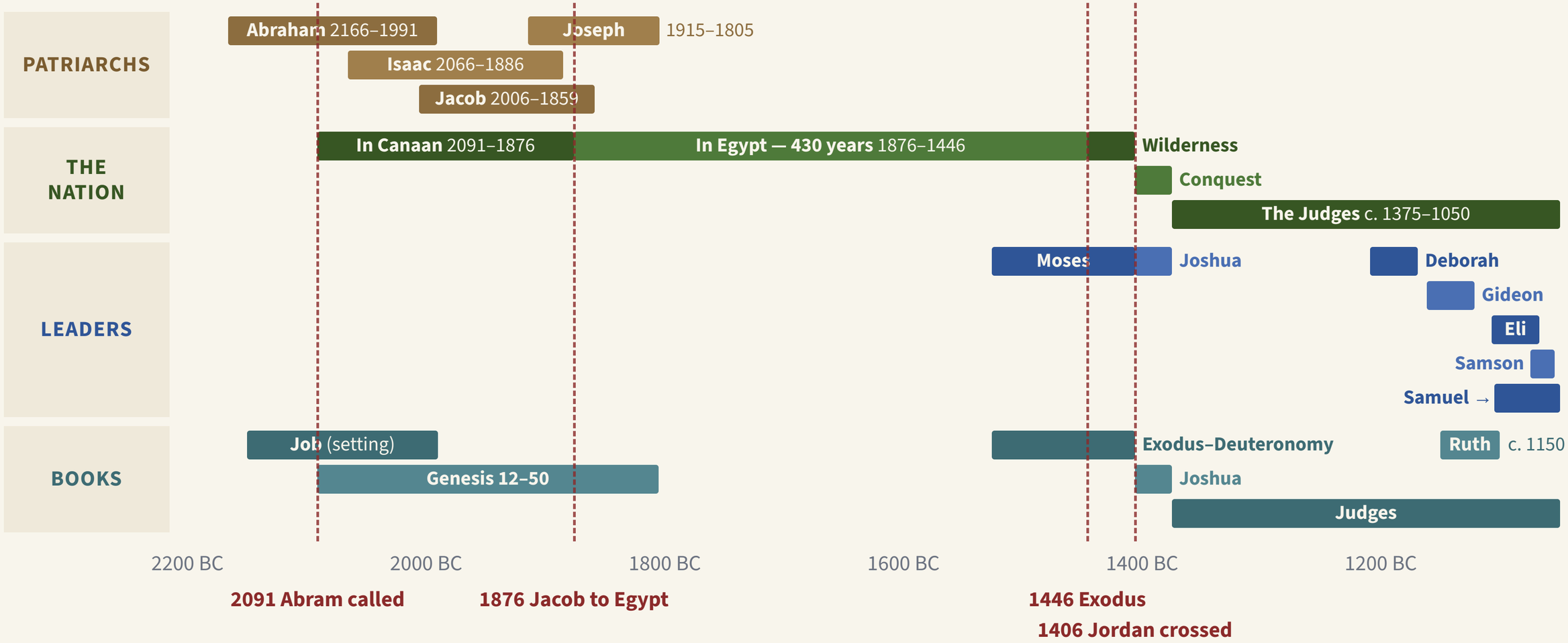
From Abraham to the Judges

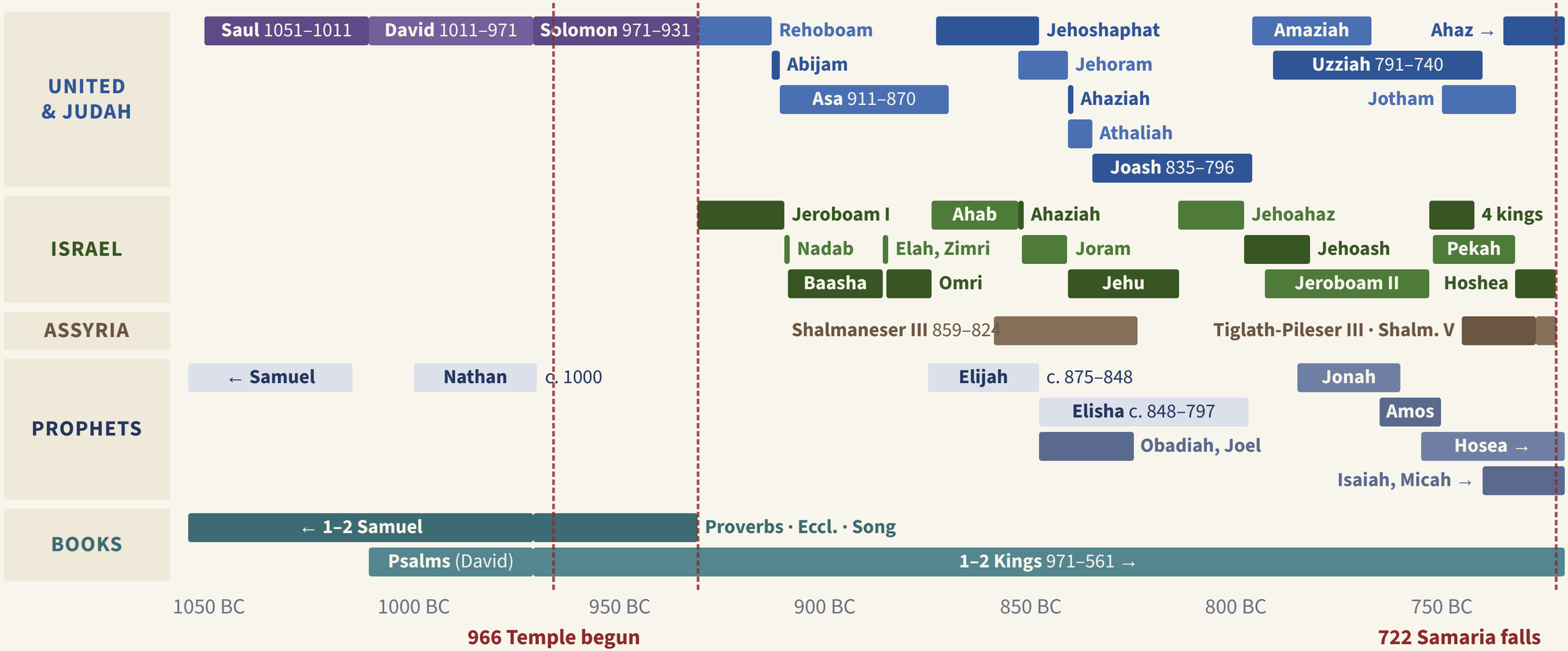
Patriarchs, the nation's beginnings, its leaders and books, 2200–1050 BC



Dates follow the early-Exodus chronology (1 Kgs 6:1; Exod 12:40). Judges' dates are approximate and overlap.

The Kingdom Years

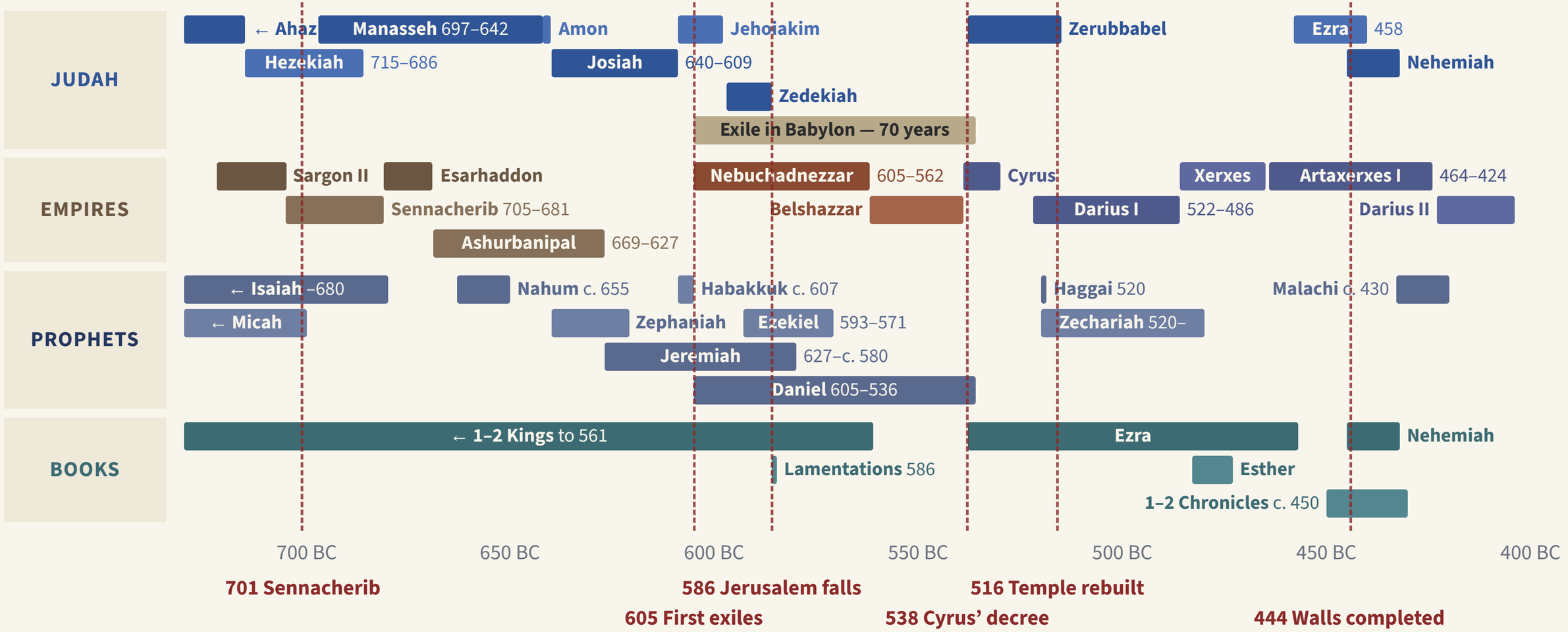
The united kingdom, Judah and Israel, Assyria, prophets and books, 1055–720 BC



Overlapping bars are co-regencies. Light prophet bars mark prophets who left no book of their own. Reign dates are in the notes.

Exile and Return

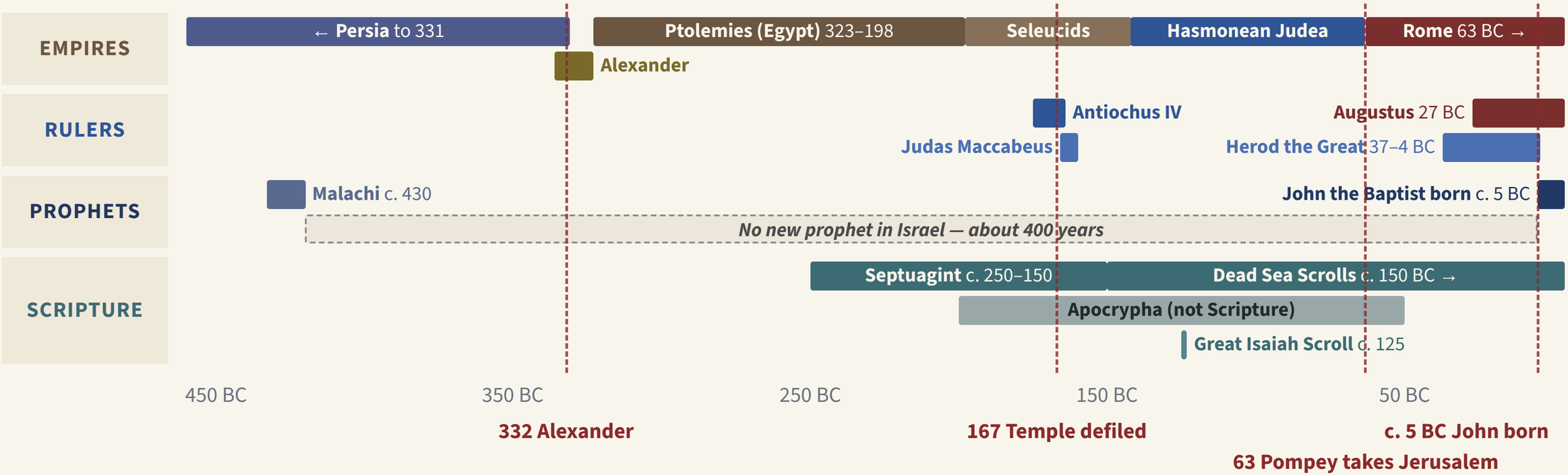
Judah alone, Assyria, Babylon and Persia, and the later prophets, 730–400 BC



Seventy years of exile, 605–536 BC (Jer 25:11–12; Dan 9:2). Ezra, Nehemiah and Esther are set under Persian kings.

From Malachi to John the Baptist

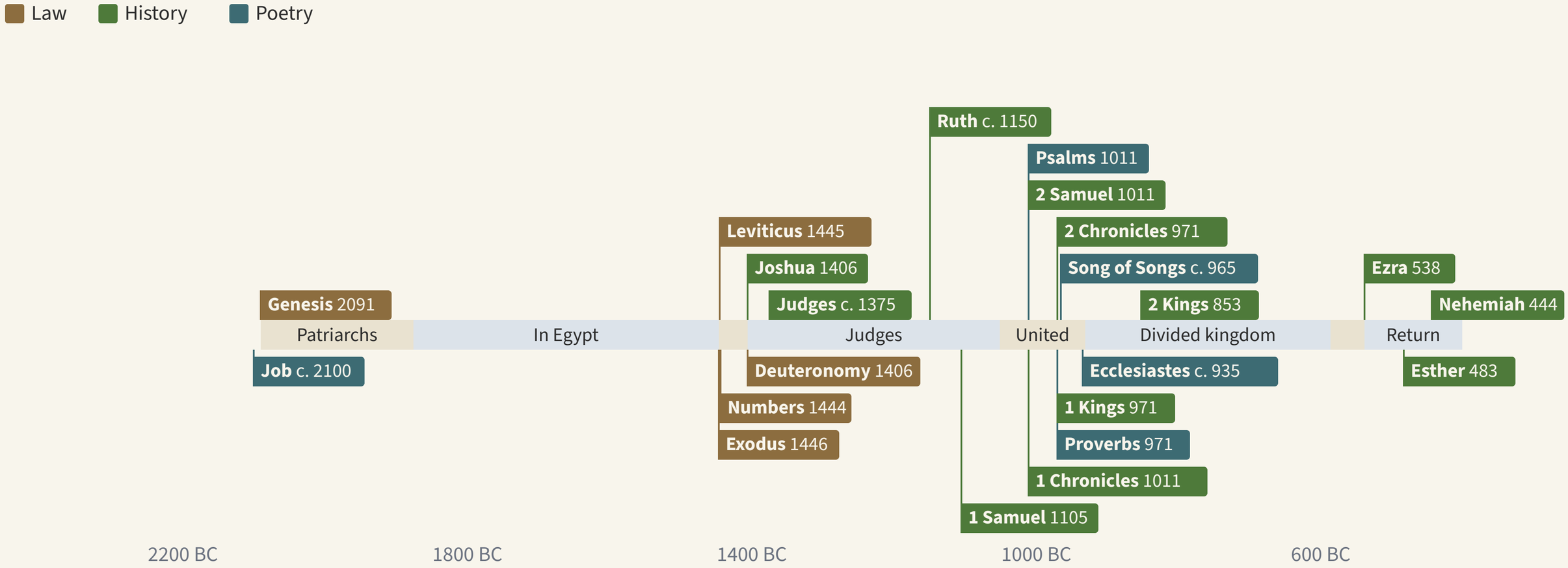
Four hundred years without a new prophet, 460 BC–AD 5



Malachi closes the Old Testament with the promise of Elijah (Mal 4:5–6). The story continues in the New Testament Timeline.

Old Testament Books at a Glance: Law, History and Poetry

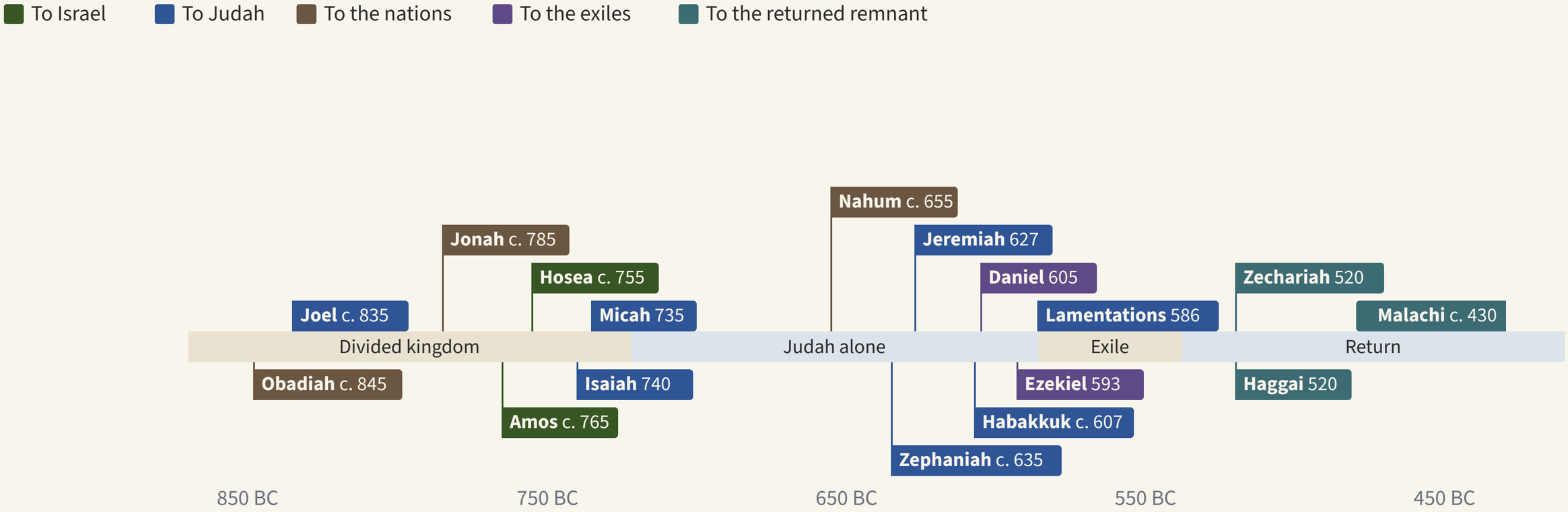
Each book flagged where its story begins or is set



Genesis 1–11 is undated; Genesis is flagged at Abraham's call. Job's setting is placed in the patriarchal era.

Old Testament Books at a Glance: The Prophets

Each book flagged at the start of the prophet's ministry, colored by audience



Obadiah and Joel are placed by the early dating; many date them later. Lamentations is grouped with the prophets, after Jeremiah.